I am grateful to the authors, publishers and other copyright holders whose inputs and material I have used in the book. I also would like to place on record the encouragement of well-wishers like Marshal of the Air Force Arjan Singh, Shekhar Gupta, Lieutenant General V. R. Raghavan, Sushil Gupta, Anil Malhotra, Sant Singh Chatwal, Hardev Akoi, Laxmi Narayan, acclaimed photographers Henry Dallal (his work appears on the cover) and Captain Suresh Sharma, Major General Manjit Dugal, Ranjit Singh, Colonel Basudev Maitra, Ajit Singh Sawhney, Harpreet Chadha, Surinder Kandhari, Ini Bawa, G.S. Kochar, and many of my services and golfing friends. I would also like to thank Jyoti M. Rai, Indrim Boo, Bandeep Singh and Pramod Kamble for their contribution to the project.

Finally, my greatest appreciation goes to Amit Agarwal and his team at HarperCollins. Their conceptual ideas helped me in evolving and formatting the manuscript correctly while keeping the focus in place. They meticulously edited and processed my work and thereby made an admirable contribution. *Merci beaucoup a tous!*